

My Product Journey: Notebook — Product Fact Card

How to use this card: This document provides detailed information about notebooks. Read it carefully to extract facts for your graphic organiser.

Why Notebook Matters — and Where It Comes From

Notebooks are fundamental stationery products in India, used extensively by students for learning, professionals for record-keeping, and various institutions for administrative purposes. The Indian notebook market is a dynamic blend of organized players like ITC Classmate and Navneet Education Limited, who offer branded products, alongside a substantial unorganized sector providing more affordable alternatives. The industry's foundation lies in paper manufacturing, an activity with significant environmental considerations in India. Historically, India's first paper factory was established in Serampore, West Bengal, in 1812, with mechanized production commencing in the 1830s near Calcutta. The Titagarh Paper Mills, built in 1882, marked the advent of large-scale paper manufacturing. Modern key players include ITC, which launched its Classmate brand in 2003, and Navneet Education, founded in 1959, which expanded into stationery manufacturing with a facility in Daman between 1994-1995. Other major organizations contributing to the paper and notebook ecosystem include JK Paper Limited, Century Pulp and Paper, Ballarpur Industries Limited (BILT), Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Limited (TNPL), West Coast Paper Mills Limited, Emami Paper Mills Limited, and Pudumjee Pulp & Paper Mills Ltd. The primary hubs for paper and notebook manufacturing are spread across states like Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Odisha, strategically located due to raw material availability and established industrial infrastructure.

The Journey: From Raw Material to Final Product

The journey of a notebook begins with ****Raw Material Procurement**** across India. Forestry workers harvest wood and bamboo from forests, often through farm forestry programs, while farmers collect agricultural residues like bagasse and wheat straw from their fields. In urban centers, waste pickers and recycling center operators gather waste paper. Logistics coordinators then plan the transport, and truck drivers move these raw materials to paper mills, with pulpwood alone costing Rs 8,000-15,000 per tonne (FY25-26). The next stage is ****Pulping and Paper Manufacturing****, carried out by pulp mill operators, chemical engineers, and machine operators at major paper mills such as those in Pune and Ballarpur (Maharashtra), Vapi and Morbi (Gujarat), Saharanpur and Lalkuan (Uttar Pradesh), Sarapaka and Rajahmundry (Andhra Pradesh), Kagithapuram (Tamil Nadu), Dandeli (Karnataka), Titagarh (West Bengal), and Rayagada (Odisha). Here, raw materials are processed into pulp using digesters and refiners, then bleached, often by chemical engineers employing Elemental Chlorine Free (ECF) technology in bleaching towers. Paper machine operators feed the pulp into Fourdrinier machines, which dewater, press, and dry it using drying cylinders and calenders to form large paper rolls. Slitters/rewinders then cut these into smaller rolls. This stage involves significant capital expenditure, estimated at Rs 40-50 lakh per TPD. Following this, ****Paper Conversion and Printing**** takes place at

paper mills or specialized printing units in industrial clusters across Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi-NCR, Tamil Nadu, and West Bengal. Paper handlers feed large paper rolls into sheet cutting machines, and guillotine operators precisely cut them into specific notebook sheet sizes. Ruling machine operators then direct these sheets through ruling machines to apply single lines, double lines, squares, or leave them unruled. Pre-press technicians and designers prepare artwork for covers, which printing machine operators then print using offset or digital printing presses. Lamination machine operators often apply a protective layer using lamination machines, adding Rs 1-5 per notebook for printing and cutting. Finally, **Notebook Assembly and Finishing** occurs at manufacturing units nationwide. Assemblers or collating machine operators gather the cut and ruled paper sheets. Machine operators then bind these with covers using stitching machines for saddle stitching (center pinning with galvanised iron wire), perfect binding machines for gluing, or spiral binding machines for inserting coils. Edge squaring operators use edge squaring machines to trim and square the edges, and quality control inspectors perform checks. Packaging workers then pack the finished notebooks into bundles and cartons. This assembly and finishing stage adds Rs 2-10 per notebook. The final stage is **Packaging and Distribution**, where packaging machine operators or manual packers prepare notebooks for transport. Warehouse staff, logistics managers, and truck drivers then move these cartons using forklifts, delivery vans, and trucks from manufacturing units to regional warehouses, wholesale markets, and retail stores across India, reaching both urban and rural areas. Sales representatives and retail staff then make the product available to consumers, with packaging, logistics, and distribution adding Rs 1-5 per notebook to the cost.

Raw Materials, Inputs, and Natural Resources

The production of a notebook relies on several key raw materials and natural resources. The primary input is **Paper (Writing & Printing Grade)**, which is sourced from domestic paper mills located in states such as Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Odisha, Punjab, Haryana, and Assam. This paper, typically 60-90 GSM, costs between Rs 70-82 per kg as of July 2025, while Maplitho paper was priced at Rs 49-77 per kg in April 2026. The raw materials for paper itself include wood pulp, bamboo, bagasse, wheat straw, and recycled paper. **Pulpwood**, a crucial component for virgin paper production, is sourced from forest-rich regions of India, often through farm forestry programs, with prices ranging from Rs 8,000-15,000 per tonne in FY25-26. Global pulp prices, however, saw a surge to USD 650 per metric ton (approximately Rs 54,000 per MT) in April 2026 due to supply chain disruptions. **Bagasse and other Agricultural Waste**, such as wheat straw, are cost-effective raw materials, particularly in sugarcane-producing states like Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu. TNPL, for instance, utilizes bagasse for its paper production, though its availability is seasonal. The **Cover Material**, typically cardstock or paperboard, is also sourced from paper mills across India. For a 295x210mm notebook, a 220 GSM laminated and pre-printed board cost approximately Rs 3.50 per board as of October 2025. Recycled materials are increasingly used for covers. For binding, **Stitching Wire or Binding Wire** is essential, procured from manufacturers in locations like Vasai (Maharashtra), Vapi (Gujarat), Kolkata (West Bengal), and Delhi. Galvanised Iron wire, in gauges ranging from 18-24 SWG, costs Rs 80-120 per kg as of June 2026, used for saddle stitching or center pinning. Lastly, **Glue or Adhesive** is sourced from chemical manufacturers across India, used primarily for perfect binding or to secure covers.

How Notebook Is Made — Step by Step

The manufacturing of a notebook involves a precise sequence of steps, each performed by skilled workers and specialized machinery: 1. **Paper Cutting and Ruling**: Paper handlers initiate the process

by feeding large rolls of paper into high-speed sheet cutting machines. Once cut into sheets, guillotine operators precisely trim these to the specific dimensions required for notebook pages. Subsequently, ruling machine operators guide these sheets through ruling machines, which print the desired line patterns—be it single line, double line, square, or leaving them unruled. 2. **Cover Printing and Lamination:** Designers develop the aesthetic artwork for the notebook covers. Pre-press technicians then prepare these designs for printing. Printing machine operators utilize sophisticated offset or digital printing presses to apply these designs onto cardstock or paperboard. For added durability and finish, lamination machine operators often apply a protective film using lamination machines. 3. **Sheet Collation:** Assemblers or specialized collating machine operators meticulously gather the exact number of ruled paper sheets, typically ranging from 120 to 172 pages, to form the inner block of each notebook. 4. **Binding:** This crucial step involves securing the collated sheets and cover. For saddle-stitched notebooks, machine operators use stitching machines (center pin) to insert galvanised iron wire, usually 18-24 SWG, through the spine. For perfect-bound notebooks, machine operators employ perfect binding machines to apply a strong adhesive to the spine, attaching the cover securely. In the case of spiral-bound notebooks, machine operators use spiral binding machines to punch holes along the edge and insert a spiral coil. 5. **Edge Squaring and Finishing:** To achieve a neat and professional appearance, edge squaring operators utilize edge squaring machines to trim and square the edges of the newly bound notebooks. Throughout these stages, quality control inspectors perform checks to ensure product standards are met. 6. **Packaging:** Finally, packaging workers or automated packaging machine operators carefully pack the finished notebooks into bundles, which are then placed into larger cartons, ready for distribution.

What It Costs to Bring Notebook to You

The cost of a notebook builds up through several stages, starting from the raw materials. A forestry worker or farmer initially receives approximately Rs 8,000-15,000 per tonne for pulpwood, which forms the base for paper. At the paper mill, the cost of writing and printing grade paper (60-90 GSM) ranges from Rs 70-82 per kg. For a standard 120-172 page notebook, the paper alone contributes approximately Rs 20-35 to its cost, representing 40-60% of the final retail price. Additional raw materials like the cover, binding wire, and glue add another Rs 4-8 per notebook; for instance, a 220 GSM laminated cover costs about Rs 3.50, and the stitching wire adds a minimal Rs 0.90 per 300 notebooks. During the manufacturing process, labor costs, based on a daily expenditure of Rs 2,923 for producing 2400 notebooks, add Rs 1-3 per notebook. Electricity and power, consuming around Rs 400 per day for the same production volume, contribute a smaller Rs 0.15-0.20 per notebook. Overheads, encompassing rent, depreciation, and maintenance, further add Rs 2-5 per notebook. After all these costs, the manufacturer typically aims for a profit of Rs 2-5 per notebook. Finally, the wholesale and retail margins, along with logistics and distribution expenses, add Rs 5-15 per notebook before it reaches the consumer. This cumulative process results in a retail price ranging from Rs 10-260 per notebook, depending on its brand, size, page count, and binding type. Regarding taxation, notebooks, exercise books, and registers have been exempt from Goods and Services Tax (GST) at 0% after September 22, 2025. However, prior to this, they attracted 12% GST. Crucially, raw materials like paper and printing services are taxed at 18% GST. This creates an 'inverted duty structure,' meaning manufacturers cannot claim Input Tax Credit (ITC) on the higher GST paid for raw materials, leading to embedded taxes that can increase production costs and potentially influence retail prices.

What Notebook Costs in Shops — Price Research

The retail price of notebooks in India varies significantly based on brand, specifications, and the sales channel. For instance, a **Classmate Single Line Spiral Notebook with 180 Pages, A4 Size (30 x 21 cm)**, was priced at Rs 156.0 when purchased through Zepto, an online quick-delivery service in Kolkata, in June 2026. In comparison, a more basic **Classmate School Notebook, featuring 140 Pages, A4 Size, and a Single Line ruling**, was available for Rs 40.92 from Rapid Delivery Services, a general online delivery platform across India, also in June 2026. For a premium offering, the **Navneet Youva Case Bound Note Book for Executives, with 240 Pages, A4 Size (14.8 x 21 cm), and Single Line ruling**, was listed at Rs 230.0 on Navneetstore.com, the official online store, during the same period. These price differences can be attributed to several factors. Firstly, product specifications play a major role: the Classmate spiral notebook has more pages (180 vs 140) and a different binding (spiral vs. stitched) compared to the basic school notebook, justifying its higher price. The Navneet Youva executive notebook, with its higher page count (240 pages) and premium case binding, targets a different segment and commands a higher price. Secondly, the retail channel itself influences pricing. Quick-delivery apps like Zepto often have slightly higher prices to cover the immediate logistics and convenience they offer, while general online retailers like Rapid Delivery Services might focus on competitive pricing for mass-market products. Official brand stores, such as Navneetstore.com, may offer a wider range of premium products or exclusive editions, which can also carry higher price tags.

Sources & References

Paper Manufacturing Plant Cost in India: 2026 Capex Guide — https://vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com/grounding-api-redirect/AUZIYQGSbFSPyOV-MnccxLjug6iazqZdrksEgCeV1hB8xYpYoDzty6WXGCHrYnz05qJCqO_XEZ8OTFr-zrcs3Q4TsM6PB-Le1nNdqWvOMrzXDfdaX_-tU56hZugC44_5pPXpmYwbuB0BJQRm9MVJaN6f7dCXQN4O4cpiSeM6sG20hExv

Geographical Distribution of the Paper Industry in India - Vedantu — https://vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com/grounding-api-redirect/AUZIYQHnZ5rA-V-WSMmmzNly5W5PsQHxgu_gVY2KbwWjDhcfB0wbTdPRFmuX40IQ2QPyI1SwB1QJMvM-Lso7uccovh9LTPJmGcm8WYSISUH_Gb-PKdel9V__w4TyDW89HvKJVM3I0RADT29DXhkPr5YIqtNatytSPIAxfLvCMXc8LTyYTWFKBSgkNVt9cgQ-rYAuoOckvUCLJuHgs8t0=

The Art of Creating: How are Notebooks Manufactured in India - Quillkart — https://vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com/grounding-api-redirect/AUZIYQF9MoNVKUPJJmFHlp_7UgmaV588v1DnCur0146NN2X52bBLYkXoG8UNkiP6R71sAxIhLhwX8YTJQY0-zioO5Om9qOtEm_Od0ad3WLzBqYNwtV_TTu-QSG9Jl66RBdtQ8HQhcSWYxR6d4SCIPkqHiVDgvkgRlGvrMNZ9KIXnfC3jQQ4TOv5yIQtg7sPUiIk3JWiWQ==

Navneet Education - Grokipedia — <https://vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com/grounding-api-redirect/AUZIYQHd0rZsV1XjhMGmsezMRRpPcNY3buQif4fmVIVyNISJuDRuN85BCZhhrHMqtE4fZ-Ji6D0NepyCT26jrHXBz06ai2MClcpWfGW2TBjsFReBIYcj0WgPWzPlgn-1zEYY8Lq0BgectrbrWw==>